SECTION I

INTRODUCTION

Background of the System

Despera Merchandise is a final requirements CC105 for a curated collection of anime-inspired apparel, accessories, and collectibles. The project implements a business-to-customer (B2C) e-commerce workflow: customers explore a product catalog, manage a personal cart, provide a delivery location, place an order, and review order history. Administrators maintain products and categories, review orders, view store summaries, manage users, and prepare printable reports.

The application combines a responsive browser interface with a PHP API and a relational MySQL database. The user interface uses a restrained warm palette and Bootstrap-based layout. Its design notes emphasize a readable mobile/desktop experience, gentle contrast, clear iconography, and compact navigation.

Problem Statement

A small merchandise shop needs a consistent way to publish products, show stock, accept customer selections, retain order details, and support basic administration. Keeping these records in separate manual lists makes it harder to keep product availability, cart contents, order totals, payment status, and customer history aligned. This project addresses the need for one connected demonstration system that supports these routine customer and administrative tasks.

Objectives

General objective: develop a web-based B2C merchandise system that demonstrates the essential customer shopping lifecycle and administrator catalog and order management.

- Provide account registration, sign-in, session persistence, profile and delivery-location management.
- Allow customers to browse, search, inspect, and add available merchandise to a persistent cart.
- Create orders from cart contents, retain item and price snapshots, and expose order history and status.
- Give administrators catalog/category CRUD, order and user management, inventory indicators, dashboards, and printable reports.
- Use database relationships and server-side authorization to keep customer and administrative operations tied to authenticated accounts.
- Demonstrate an optional AI-assisted customer-service experience with stored conversation history and a shared request cooldown.